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THE CHANGING GEOPOLITICAL LANDSCAPE OF INDIA–RUSSIA RELATIONS

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India and Russia held their 20th annual Summit on the margins of the Eastern Economic Forum in Vladivostok in September 2019, maintaining an unbroken sequence from 2000. In their public statements, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Vladimir Putin reaffirmed the strength of the bilateral strategic partnership and committed themselves to broadening the economic agenda of India–Russia cooperation beyond defence. Agreements were signed to promote trade and investment in connectivity, infrastructure, and energy. The Vladivostok Summit was also a renewed assertion of India's strategic autonomy in the face of continuing pressure from the United States to dilute relations with Russia. At the 19th Summit in New Delhi in October 2018, India had gone through with a contract for the acquisition of the Russian air defence system S-400, despite strong US exhortations against it. Further defence cooperation was discussed at the Vladivostok summit.

A new dimension was added to the relationship by Prime Minister Modi's announcement of an "Act Far East" initiative,